

UA Takes Twin Bill From UTEP

By ABE CHANIN
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EL PASO — Arizona hung in the Western Athletic Conference baseball race on the thread of two dropped balls and a slashing double by J. Ray Rokey.

The Wildcats are still two games behind the southern division leader, Arizona State, which

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yesterday finished a sweep of a series from New Mexico.

Arizona's hopes of catching the Sun Devils almost faded completely away in the last inning of a doubleheader here yesterday. The Cats had clubbed Texas-EI Paso, 8-5, in the

WAC Standings

Southern Division			
	W	L	Pct.
Arizona State	8	1	.889
Arizona	6	3	.667
UTEP	2	7	.222
New Mexico	2	7	.222

Saturday's Results

Arizona 8-6, UTEP 3-4
Arizona State 13-9, New Mexico 2-5

nine-inning opener and shot away to a 3-0 lead in the seven-inning nightcap.

But the Texans took advantage of the wildness of Fred Burns and scored four runs in the fifth to lead 4-3. Juan Sandoval, all of 125 pounds and hitless in 10 previous bats in the series, singled in two of those runs for the Miners.

Arizona still trailed coming into the seventh. Jim Williams drew a walk to open the inning but Lynn Hunt got the next two batters, bringing Danny Joe Ryan to the plate. Ryan hit a soft grounder to the second baseman and he threw the ball to first.

The few fans in the park shouted in ecstasy as they thought their Miners had broken a six-game losing streak. But first baseman Larry Currie dropped the ball.

Up came Rich Hinton and the Miners again missed a chance to end the game when catcher Rich Meyer, whose family once lived in Tucson, dropped a foul fly.

Hinton then dropped a wind-blown double into right field to tie the game. Up came Rokey for his second double of the game that brought in the two runs that gave Arizona its 6-4 victory.

Andy Cohen, the former major leaguer who's a part time coach of UTEP, was disconsolate after the game. He said, "We had it won, not once but twice. I told that boy, Currie, to turn in his uniform. I hated to do it, but he's been killing us like that all season."

Frank Sancel remarked, "Well, I guess everyone had us counted out, but we've come back in this race and we can win it if the boys want to do the job."

Arizona plays Arizona State in Phoenix this Friday and Saturday, and the Wildcats, who now have a 31-5 record, know they must win all three to stay in contention.

Arizona has won six in a row now after players held a secret meeting following a loss to New Mexico in Tucson. In yesterday's doubleheader Arizona had five doubles, five triples and two home runs. And many of the extra-base blows were aided by winds that reached 30 miles per hour.

Leon Hooten pushed his record to 10-1 in the first game on a shaky pitching performance that saw him give up only five hits, but walk nine, strike out nine, throw two wild pitches and also commit three fielding errors.

Bob Bridges, his relief, saved the win for him. Dave Frost, homered and tripled in the first game and Williams hit two triples plus a home run.

In the second game, Bryan Shields was the winner in relief as he blanked the Texans who are now 13-19 in two innings of pitching.

Tim Gump who was injured in Friday's game here was still unable to play yesterday and will be on the doubtful list all this week. His right knee, chronically injured, popped out of place as he swung at a pitch last night.

Arizona tunes up for the ASU series Tuesday against the nation's No. 2 small college team, Grand Canyon.